MIL-T-40620A

6 June 1966

SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-40620
6 April 1962

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

TAPE, PRESSURE-SENSITIVE ADHESIVE, LITHOGRAPH

This specification is mandatory for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

* 1.1 This specification covers a plastic film pressure-sensitive tape designed for masking lithographic and photographic negatives.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-T-680 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Packing and Packaging Of.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 147 - Gummed and Pressure Sensitive Tapes: Methods of Testing.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7510

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Tape.- The tape shall be a ruby red tinted translucent plastic film, free from pinholes, completely and uniformly coated on one side with a clear pressure-sensitive adhesive. The adhesive shall not be covered by a liner. The tape shall possess the physical properties listed in table I when tested as specified in 4.2.3.

TABLE I.- Physical properties of tape

Property	Requirement
Thickness	0.0029 inch maximum
Tensile strength	20 pounds/inch width (min.)
Adhesion	20 ounces/inch width (min.)
Mending stability	No adhesion

3.2 Dimensions.-

3.2.1 Width.- The width of the finished tape shall be as specified (see 6.2). A tolerance of ± 1/32 inch shall be permitted.

3.2.2 Length.- Tape shall be furnished in rolls of not less than 72 yards in length. Tape shall be evenly wound, adhesive side in, on cores of sufficient rigidity to prevent distortion of the rolls under normal conditions of transportation, storage and use. The core shall have an inside diameter of 3 inches ± 1/16, - 0 inch, and cord width shall be the same as the width of tape furnished.

3.3 Unrolling properties.- Tape, as received, shall exhibit no separation of adhesive from the backing and shall not tear upon unwinding of the rolls.

3.4 Splices.- Tape shall be in one continuous strip. Not more than three splices (4 pieces) shall be permitted in any single roll. The spliced area shall not separate when tape is unwound from the roll.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Color and transparency.- The finished tape shall be ruby red in color and of sufficient transparency to permit the reading of 5 point printed type, after the tape has been applied over the printed matter.

3.6 Marking of rolls.- Each roll of tape sold on Government order or contract shall be marked in or on the edge of the core with numerals or letters indicating the month and year of manufacture. In addition, the manufacturer's name and designation of the product shall be stamped in the core.

3.7 Workmanship.- The tape shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. All edges shall be clean-cut. The tape shall be free from tears, cuts, holes (including pinholes) and uncoated areas. The adhesive coating shall be smooth and uniform and free from lumps, dirt or any foreign matter. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-105 except where otherwise indicated herein.

* 4.2.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Examination of the end item.- The end item shall be examined in accordance with applicable subparagraphs at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) set forth in 4.2.1.5 for visual, dimensional and average length per roll. In so far as practicable no more than two (2) rolls of tape shall be drawn from any one shipping container from each lot for each width of material offered for visual, dimensional and average length inspection. The lot size for purposes of determining the sample size in accordance with MIL-STD-105 shall be expressed in units of rolls of the specified width of tape. The sample unit shall be one roll of tape of the specified width.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination.- The end item shall be examined for defects in appearance and workmanship.

Examine	Defect
Appearance	Tape does not consist of a backing with a coating of adhesive on one side only.
	Not colored ruby red.
	Transparency not sufficiently clear to permit easy reading of 5 point type when tape is applied directly over printed matter.
Workmanship	Surfaces not thoroughly clean; not free of lint, dust, or grit; presence of foreign matter, dirty areas or spots.
	Tear, cut, puncture, or hole (including pinholes).
	Adhesive coating not uniformly and smoothly applied over entire area of one side of backing; any bare spots or lumps.

4.2.2.2 Examination of the end item for defects in dimension and construction.- Any dimension not within specified tolerances, or construction of roll not as specified, shall be classified as a defect.

Examine	Defect
Assembly of roll	Material not wound evenly and neatly on core causing soft or uneven edges, or telescoping of roll.
	Adhesive side not wound on inside of roll.
	Edges not clean cut; ragged, nicked, crushed, or uneven edges.
	Identification markings omitted, incorrect, incomplete, illegible, or not as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect
Width of tape	Varies by more than ± 1/32 inch from width specified.
Core	Not same width as tape; broken, crushed, mutilated, or collapsed.
	Inside diameter less than 3 inches or greater than 3-1/16 inches.
	Not suitably strong and rigid.
Unwinding of roll	When unwound, material sticks together to the extent that unrolling causes tearing or injury to any surface; adhesive coating separates from backing; adhesive coating removes color from back of adjacent layer.
	Tape wound unevenly causing wrinkles or creases within roll.
	Does not unroll evenly and uniformly without a tendency to curl transversely.
	Backing breaks, delaminates, or splits during unwinding.
	More than 3 splices in roll; splices not evenly and neatly made; splice comes apart during unwinding.

4.2.2.3 Examination of the end item for average length per roll.- The average length per roll shall be not less than the specified or indicated length, for lot acceptability.

* 4.2.2.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made in accordance with the provisions of PPP-T-680 to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of Section 5 of this specification are complied with. The inspection level for this examination shall be S-2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.2.5 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) for examinations.- The inspection levels, for determining the sample size, and the acceptable quality levels (AQLs), expressed in defects per 100 units, shall be as follows:

Examination paragraph 1/	Inspection levels	(AQLs)
4.2.2.1	I	4.0
4.2.2.2	S-2	2.5
4.2.2.3	S-2	N/A

1/ The same rolls of material shall be used for the examinations under 4.2.2.2 and 4.2.2.3 and shall be within the rolls randomly selected for the examination under 4.2.2.1.

4.2.3 Testing of the end item.- The end item shall be tested for the applicable characteristics as indicated in table II for each lot of material presented for examination. The sample unit as referenced herein, is defined as the amount of material required to perform all tests one time. The sample unit for tests shall be one roll of the specified width. Each sample unit for tests shall be taken from a different package and insofar as practicable shall be taken from a different shipping container for better representation of the lot. Five sample units, randomly selected, shall be tested from each lot with no evidence of failure to meet unit or average requirements, as applicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR TESTING

TABLE II

CHARACTERISTIC	Specification Reference		Requirements Applicable To		Number Determinations Per Unit	Results Reported As		Inspect Level	AQL
	Requirement	Test Method 1/	Individ Unit	Lot Aver		Pass or Fail 5/	Numerically to Nearest 6/		
Thickness	3.1	Method 36 2/	-	X	Average of 3 per strip on 3 strips	-	0.0001 in.		
Tensile strength (longitudinal)	3.1	Method 30	-	X	Average of 10	-	lbs/inch width.		
Bending stability	3.1	Method 98 3/	X	-	1	X	-		
Adhesion	3.1	Method 10 4/	-	X	Average of 10	-	0.1oz/in. width.		

NOTE: 1/ The first 3 laps of tape from each roll shall be removed before taking specimens for testing. An equal number of specimens shall be tested from all sample rolls. Conditioning and testing, as applicable, shall be as specified in Fed. Test Method Std. No. 147.

2/ The test specimen shall be a minimum of 3 inches in length and shall have a width as specified in the contract or order.

3/ Except that the specimen width shall be the width of the tape as specified and the total weight applied shall be adjusted to give 1/2 pound per square inch pressure on the test strips.

4/ Except that the test specimen width for tapes less than 1 inch wide shall be the width of the tape specified and results shall be calculated in ounces per inch width.

5/ If failure is indicated, report description of failure.

6/ Test reports shall include all values on which results are based.

MIL-T-40620A

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-02-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Levels A and C.- The tape shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-T-680.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Levels A, B and C.- The tape shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of PPP-T-680.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with PPP-T-680.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The tape is intended for masking, edging and striping photographic and lithographic negatives.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Width.

(c) The quantity, number of rolls, linear yards of tape required.

(d) Selection of the applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Marginal identification.- The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes, additions, modifications, corrections, deletions from the previous issue have been made. This was done as a convenience only, and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on its entire content; irrespective of the marginal notations and their relationship to the preceding issue.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20260-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Custodians:

Army - GL

Navy - SA

Air Force - 69

Review activities:

Army - GL, MO, SM

Navy - SA

Air Force - 69

User activities:

Navy - MC, WP

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 7510-0159

Review and User information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing of DOD Documents.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Lithograph MIL-T-40620A

ORGANIZATION	CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO.	QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED	DOLLAR AMOUNT
		$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)*	DATE

DD FORM 1 OCT 64 1426

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
U. S. Army Natick Laboratories
Natick, Massachusetts 01762

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

OFFICIAL BUSINESS

Commanding General
U. S. Army Natick Laboratories
ATTN: AMXRE-SS
Natick, Massachusetts 01762

FOLD

"to detach this form, cut along this line"

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T19:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.